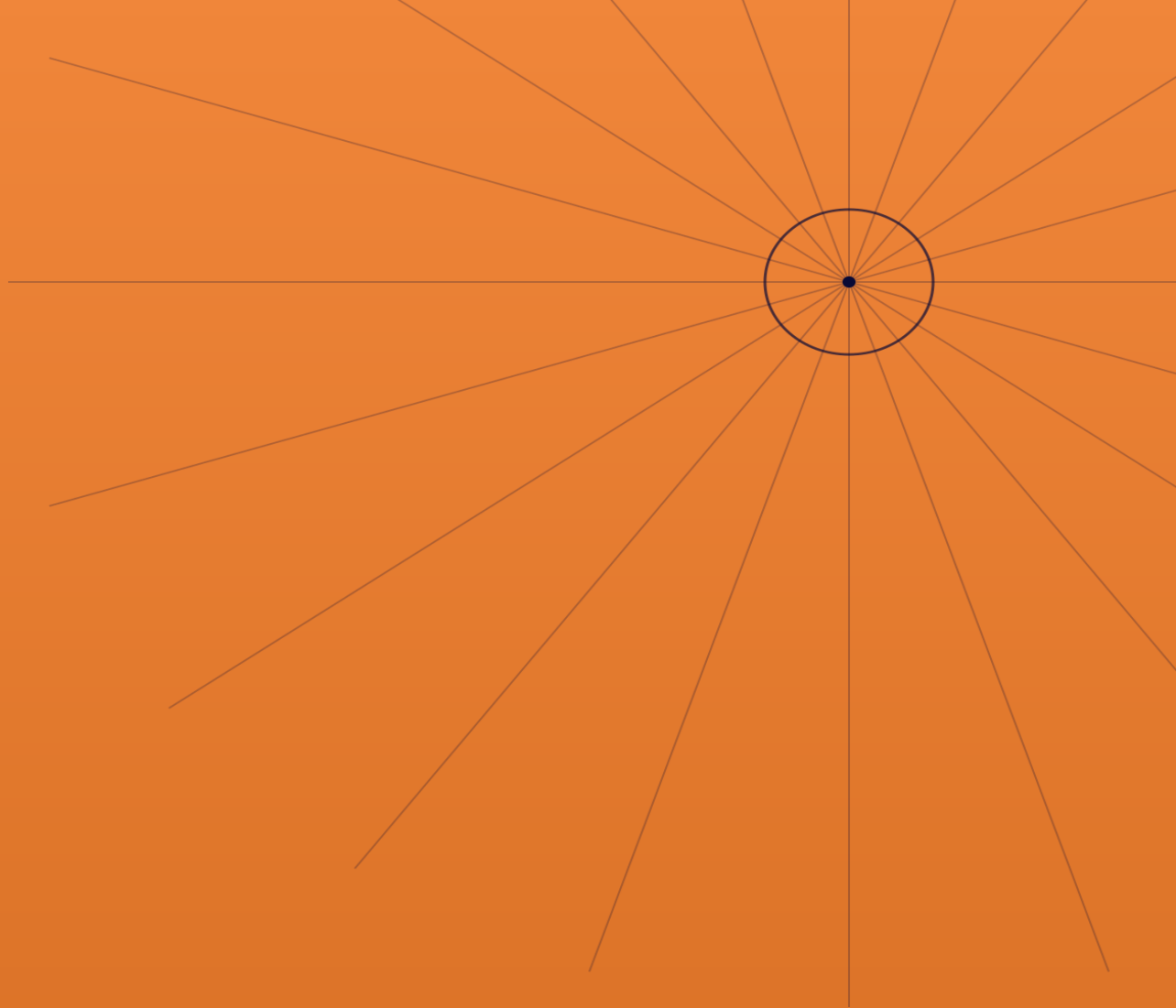




THE TIME MACHINE

An Invention in Four Dimensions

H. G. WELLS

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Chapter One — The Inventor's Demonstration

The Time Traveller, as we shall call him, was expounding a recondite matter to us with a peculiar twinkling smile, his pale grey eyes shining and flashing with the excitement of a man who has finally proved his point.

"Any real body," he said, "must have extension in four directions: it must have Length, Breadth, Thickness, and Duration. There is no difference between Time and any of the three dimensions of Space except that our consciousness moves along it."

He placed a small brass and ivory model on the table, no larger than a clock, and asked us each in turn to satisfy ourselves there was no trickery about it.

Chapter Two — Departure

The laboratory grew very still. Outside, the ordinary evening went on without us — a dog barking, a gate latch, the small unhurried business of a world about to be left behind.

He took his seat upon the saddle of the machine, one hand resting lightly on the starting lever, and looked at us for a long moment as though committing the room to memory.

Then, with no more ceremony than a man stepping into a cab, he pushed the lever over, and the machine and its rider swayed, grew indistinct, and were gone.